

Q&A

Your Questions, Our Answers

Don't Do That!

Q Recently, I visited some Web sites and clicked on certain links that offered free screensaver downloads. Ever since, my PC has been plagued by spyware and adware. As a result, whenever I am online, many pop-up windows open by themselves. What do I do?

Abhishek Ramesh

A In order to get rid of spyware and adware from your computer, you should install a good anti-spyware such as AD-Aware from www.lavasoftusa.com and update its definition files prior to thoroughly scanning your hard drive.

Not all spyware and adware can be deleted by a single anti-spyware software and hence you should also install another good anti-spyware such as Microsoft AntiSpyware from www.microsoft.com, update its definition files and run a scan to minimize the chance of any spyware and adware surviving on your PC.

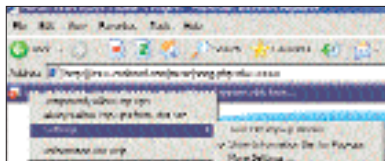
Help Blocker?

Q I have Office 2003 installed. Under the Help menu, when I click on Microsoft Office Online for help, the Help window does not appear, and an information bar appears at the top of the window. I have Windows XP Professional SP2.

V Mahendra

A This happens because of the pop-up blocking feature of the version of Internet Explorer 6 that comes with Service Pack 2. You could override the pop-up blocker: click on the link that opens the pop-up window, while keeping [Ctrl] pressed. To temporarily enable pop-up windows, click on the Information Bar at the top of the window, click "Temporarily Allow Pop-ups." When you shut down the IE window, this temporary permission will be revoked, restoring the original pop-up blocking settings.

In the second method, you could permanently enable pop-up windows on the Microsoft Office Online Web site: click on the Information Bar, click on "Always Allow Pop-ups from This Site," and when prompted with the message "Would you like to allow pop-ups from 'office.microsoft.com'?" click Yes. This



Temporarily turn off IE's pop-up blocker

will permanently set the pop-up blocker to Off for this Web site.

If for some reason you wish to restore the original pop-up window settings for this Web site, open Internet Explorer. Click on the Tools menu, point to Pop-up Blocker, and click on Pop-up Blocker Settings. In the "Allowed Sites" list, click on office.microsoft.com, then click on Remove followed by Close.

The More, The Merrier

Q I have an HP Pavilion w5130in PC with Intel GMA900 onboard graphics. I recently upgraded my PC to 512 MB of RAM. My onboard graphics is using 8 MB of memory, and I wish to upgrade its memory too. Is this possible?

Mithik Biswas

A While it not possible to upgrade the memory of onboard graphics, it is certainly possible to increase the amount of shared memory that you can allocate to it. To do this, enter the BIOS and go to the Advanced Peripherals Setup, under which you will be able to find the option to increase the amount of onboard graphics shared memory.

Admin Autopatched!

Q I have Windows XP Professional. I loaded AutoPatcher XP from your November 2005 DVD, and on the same day, I updated Windows via windowsupdate.com. The problem is that now, a Guest account login icon is available instead of the Administrator login, so I can't log in as Administrator. The other account I have is a limited account, and is of no use—I can't install software or make changes to my system settings.

Venkat

A Your Guest account icon is now visible because your Guest account, which must have been disabled thus far, has been enabled. Even though you may not be able to view your Administrator account, you will still be able to log in to it by pressing the Ctrl-Alt-Delete key combination twice at the login screen. Enter "administrator" as the username, and your administrator password. You may then change the type of the account you already have from Limited to Computer Administrator.

Update And Patch

Q I have an Intel Pentium 4 3.0 GHz, an Intel D915GVWB motherboard, 512 MB of RAM and an 80 GB SATA hard drive with Windows XP Pro SP2. Whenever I run games such as *Age of Mythology*, *Age of Titans* and such, the game crashes to the desktop after a while. I'm using the onboard graphics and sound.

V Phani Sekhar

A Download and install the latest version of the graphics and sound drivers from Intel's Web site. Also download the latest version of DirectX from Microsoft's Web site. And finally, download the latest patches for your games from their respective sites.